

Martina Uccioli

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge (MA), USA
Visiting Assistant Professor, 2025

University of Nottingham, School of Economics, Nottingham, UK
Assistant Professor, 2023 -

IZA Institute of Labor Economics, Berlin, Germany
Postdoctoral Scholar, 2023-2024

AFFILIATIONS

RFBerlin Research Affiliate	2025-
CESifo Research Network Affiliate	2025-
IZA Research Fellow	2025-

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge (MA), USA
Ph.D. in Economics, 2023

Thesis: *Essays in Labor Economics*

Supervisors: Amy Finkelstein, Simon Jäger, Daron Acemoglu

University of Oxford, Oxford, UK
Master of Philosophy in Economics, 2015
Distinction

Princeton University, Princeton (NJ), USA
Visiting student in Economics, 2012-2013

Università Commerciale Luigi Bocconi, Milan, Italy
Bachelor of International Economics, Management and Finance, 2013
110/110 Cum Laude

GRANTS

British Academy/Leverhulme Small Research Grant (£9,991)	2025
Cornell Seed Grant (co-PI; PI: Jason Sockin) (\$11,000)	2025
CITP Innovation Fund (£16,000)	2024

FELLOWSHIPS

NBER Pre-Doctoral Fellowships in Retirement and Disability Policy Research	2020-2022
Jerry A. Hausman Graduate Dissertation Fellowships	2020-2022
MIT Economics Departmental Fellowship	2018-2019
Bank of Italy “Ando-Modigliani” Fellowship	2017-2018
Bocconi-ISU Scholarship	2012-2013

RESEARCH PAPERS

“What Works for Working Couples? Work Arrangements, Maternal Labor Supply, and the Division of Home Production” (with Ludovica Ciasullo)

We provide the first causal evidence that changes to work arrangements – in the form of greater schedule regularity – can reduce the child penalty in earnings for women. The Australian 2009 Fair Work Act explicitly entitled parents of young children to request a change in work arrangements. Leveraging variation in the timing of the law, timing of childbirth, and the bite of the law across different occupations and industries, we establish three main results. First, new mothers used the Fair Work Act to maintain a regular schedule while reducing hours upon childbirth. Second, thanks to increased regularity, working mothers’ child penalty declined from a 47 to a 38 percent drop in hours worked. Third, while this increase in maternal labor supply implies a significant shift towards equality in the female- and male-shares of household income, we do not observe any changes in the female share of home production.

“Employment Protection and the Direction of Technology Adoption” (with Andrea Manera)

We study the impact of employment protection legislation (EPL) on firms’ innovation, through an event-study analysis of labor market reforms occurring in Europe over 2000-2016. Data from the Community Innovation Survey reveal that substantial drops in EPL for temporary workers prompt a reallocation of innovation towards the introduction of new products, away from process innovation aimed at cutting labor costs. Among innovative firms, the share of product innovators increases by 15% of the pre-reform value, while the share of firms specializing in process innovation falls by 35%. We develop a theoretical framework of directed technical change to rationalize our findings.

“Optimal Labor Income Taxation in the Assortative Matching Model” (2015)

I consider an assortative matching model in which workers who differ in ability match with firms which differ in size. I first extend the original (Beckerian) model in order to account for endogenous labor supply choice, and show that in this case positive assortative matching is optimal when the firms’ production function is supermodular and the worker cost of effort function is submodular, or vice-versa. I then derive the optimal linear tax rate in presence of assortative matching, and compare it with the tax rate in Rothschild and Scheuer’s (2011) Self-Confirming Policy Equilibrium (SCPE), the tax policy believed to be optimal by a government that assumes a frictionless labor market with exogenous wages. I show that the rigidities introduced by assortative matching make the optimal linear tax rate generally larger than the one in the SCPE when the effect on firms’ profits is not taken into account (partial equilibrium), but the optimal linear tax rate is typically smaller than the one in the SCPE when general equilibrium effects are considered.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

“The Effects of Sectoral Bargaining: Quasi-Experimental Evidence from Contract Extensions in Germany” (with Alexander Busch, Simon Jäger, Benjamin Schoefer, and Kilian Weil)

“Full-Time Mothers, Part-Time Workers” (with Ludovica Ciasullo, and Valeria Zurla)

“Gender Norms and Household Responses to Economic Shocks” (with Isabel Di Tella)

“The Right To Disconnect” (with Jason Sockin, Francesca Truffa, and Ashley Wong)

TEACHING	MIT 14.661 Labor Economics I (graduate)	2025
	Nottingham ECON2006 Applied Econometrics II (undergraduate)	2025
	MIT 14.32 Econometric Data Science (undergraduate) - Teaching Assistant to Professor Josh Angrist	2023
	MIT 14.13 Psychology and Economics (undergraduate) - Teaching Assistant to Professor Frank Schilbach	2023
	MIT 14.33 Research and Communication in Economics (undergraduate) - Teaching Assistant to Professor Simon Jäger	2022

RELEVANT PAST POSITIONS	Research Assistant to Simon Jäger and Benjamin Schoefer (MIT)	2019-2020
	Research Assistant to Daron Acemoglu and Pascual Restrepo (MIT)	2018
	Research Assistant to Ivan Werning and Arnaud Costinot (MIT)	2018
	Research Assistant to Amy Finkelstein (NBER)	2015-2017
	Research Intern (Oxera, Economic consulting)	2014

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES **Referee:** Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economic Studies, American Economic Review: Insights, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Human Resources, European Economic Review, Organization Science, Southern Economic Journal, Work, Employment and Society

Workshop Organization: Nottingham GEP Labour and Globalisation Workshop (2024, 2025, 2026)

Service: Nottingham Globalisation and Economic Policy (GEP) Center seminar organizer (2024-25), Graduate Economic Association (GEA) co-president (2018-19), MIT third-fourth year lunch co-organizer (2019-21), MIT Labor coffee co-organizer (2020-22), MIT Application Assistance and Mentorship Program (2020)

Panels: Royal Economic Society Expert Workshop: How to Prepare for the European Job Market for Economists (2024)

PRESENTATIONS (Including scheduled)

2026: Seminars: University of St. Andrews

2025: Seminars: Stanford University, Tufts University, London School of Economics (Center for Economic Performance), Center for Inclusive Trade Policy (CITP)

Keynotes: BeNA Workshop

Conferences and Workshops: NBER Summer Institute (GITE), CESifo Area Conference on Labor Economics, Barcelona Summer Forum (Income Dynamics and the Family), Gender in the Global Economy Workshop (Barnard College, Columbia University), Workshop Mend the Gap in Economic Opportunities (by Axa Gender Lab at Bocconi University, Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance [EIEF], and the World Bank), Society of Economics of the Household (SEHO), Sixth World Labor Conference hosted by SOLE

2024: Seminars: ECARES at the Université libre de Bruxelles, Bonn BGSE Applied Microeconomics Workshop, Office of Tax Analysis at the US Treasury*, ROKWOOL Foundation Berlin Brown Bag, RWI Berlin Network Seminar, Loughborough University

Conferences and Workshops: European Labor Symposium for Early Career Economists (ELSE), Society for Economic Dynamics (SED), Society of Labor Economists (SOLE), Italian Association of Labour Economists (AIEL), IZA Research Retreats, Badolato Labour and Organization Workshop (BLOW), BeNA conference, COunterfactual Methods for Policy Impact Evaluation (COMPIE), IEA-WB Conference Gender Norms and the Law*, CSWEP session at the ASSA Meetings*

2023: Seminars: Harvard Business School (Business, Government & the International Economy), Carlson School of Management (Department of Work and Organizations), Collegio Carlo Alberto, Centre for Studies in Economics and Finance & Department of Economics and Statistics (DISES) of the University of Naples Federico II, University of Nottingham, Bank of Italy, Department of Economics at IESE business school, Carnegie Mellon University's Heinz College, Bank of Spain, Fed Board, University of York, WU Vienna University of Economics and Business

Conferences and Workshops: Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE) Gender, Society of Economics of the Household (SEHO)*, European Economic Association (EEA), HILDA Survey Research Conference at the Melbourne Institute

2022: Society of Labor Economists (SOLE)

2021: IZA Workshop: Labor Market Institutions*, European Economic Association (EEA), European Association of Labour Economists (EALE)

*coauthor presenting